



Figure 3: Subscription page settings



Figure 4: Importing subscribers

you recall, at the beginning of the article, I did mention that you should be on a VPS or dedicated server. These servers should be on a static IP and not on a DHCP.

Your mail server should have a DNS and RDNS entry in your DNS zone file

Earlier, we had created an 'A' record in the DNS zone file that pointed to the server. An 'A' record is looked up by the browser and other programs to resolve the domain name to an IP address. You should create an RDNS or Reverse DNS entry (also known as PTR) to let recipient mail servers look up the URL from the IP address sent in the email packet. This is one way of ensuring that the email is not spoofed and its origin is trustworthy. To create a RDNS record:

1. Create an RDNS zone.
2. If your IP address is 123.456.789.81, drop the last octet and reverse the string so that the RDNS is 789.456.123
3. Append *.in-addr.arpa* to the string above to get 789.456.123.in-addr.arpa. This is the hostname for the RDNS zone.
4. Add a new PTR record and use the last octet of your IP address (81) for the name. Enter the domain name for the CNAME.

Have different mail IDs for different purposes

In an organisation, you will send email communications for different purposes. As a good practice, you should use a different ID for each of these purposes. If you send a monthly newsletter, then the sender ID should be set to *newsletters@yourdomain.com*. All promotional mailers should have a sender ID like *promotions@yourdomain.com*, and so on. You should ensure that this is configured in PHPLIST. Remember that this is a 'send only' email ID and it need not exist. And yes, any mails to this ID will result in a bounce, which is the reason for ensuring we have a 'Reply to' address.

Finalise the 'From' and 'Reply to' addresses

Even if you include a note telling people not to reply to the email, it's highly unlikely that someone will notice your note before hitting the 'Reply to' button on their email clients. So it's a good practice to include a 'Reply to' header and associate an address with it.

If you associate an address with it, then you should ensure that you have an actual email box associated with this address. You can do this by signing up with an email service or by setting up Postfix, Dovecot or Squirrelmail on a server. If you purchase an email service, then the MX records are set up by the provider. If you roll out your own, ensure that you create the MX records in your DNS Zone file. This is because the email clients look up the MX records for transporting email from the client PC to the mail server or MTA.

Have a different 'Reply to' address

Just as you have different email IDs for different purposes, it's a good practice to have a different 'Reply to' address for each